Management Information Systems

Week 1 Part I

Kangah Park (k.park@postech.ac.kr)

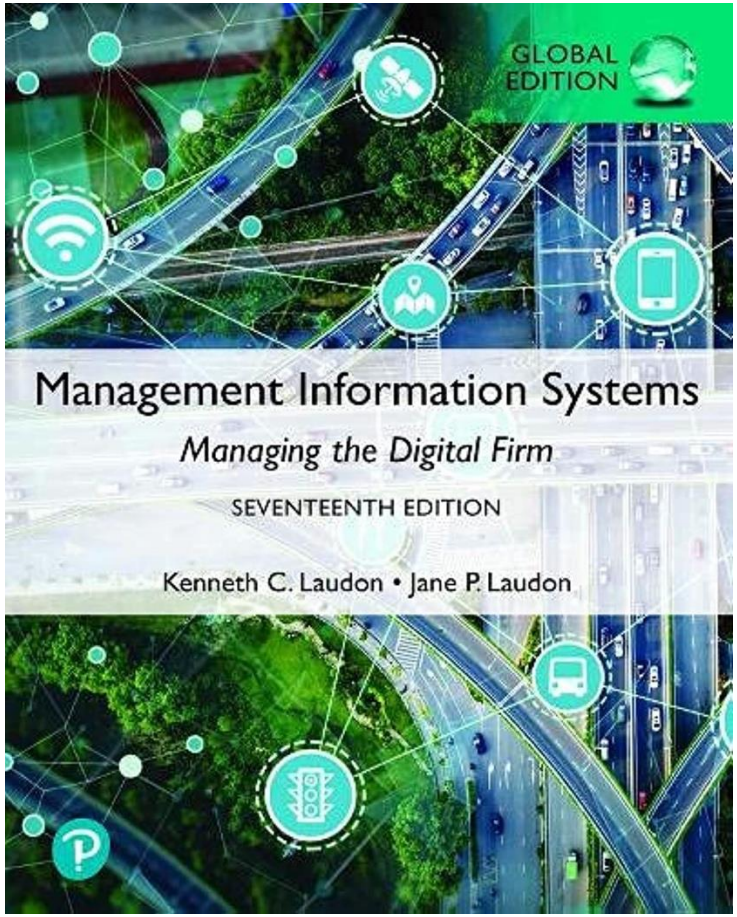
POSTECH
POHANG UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Week 1

Orientation

Textbook

- **Management Information Systems: Managing the Digital Firm (17th edition) by Laudon & Laudon**



Evaluation

- **Grades will be based on a weighted average of the following activities:**

- **Attendance & Attitude (10%):**
  - Attendance: negative point (-1) for each absence
  - Attitude: positive point (+1) for each participation
- **Midterm (25%) and final exam (25%)**
- **In-class activities (40%)**

Class Format

- **Lectures**

- **In-class activities**
  - This includes quizzes, short write-ups, and
  - Team discussions
  - ***No take-home assignments!***

- **Active participation is strongly encouraged.**

Goal of this course

- **Understand major organizational information systems**
- **Apply them to real-world business problems**
- **Practice human thinking without AI support**

THE CHOSUN Daily

MIT Study: AI Writing Lowers Brain Activity

MIT: ChatGPT users show 55% lower brain activity than direct writers

By Kim Min-ki

Updated 2026.02.09. 13:33

Literacy is not merely the ability to read letters but a 'thinking process' of interpreting information and reconstructing it with one's own logic. The pinnacle of this process is writing. However, as more people entrust this writing to generative AI, concerns arise that the muscles of thought may atrophy.

In fact, a research team from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) in the U.S. announced research findings indicating that brain activity decreases when writing using generative AI. The researchers divided 54 participants aged 18 to 39 into three groups over four months last year and had them write SAT (U.S. college entrance qualification exam) essays four times. One group used 'ChatGPT,' another used the Google search engine, and the last group wrote essays directly.

After measuring brain waves, it was found that the group aided by AI exhibited the lowest brain activity. The group that wrote using ChatGPT showed up to 55% lower intensity of information transfer between brain regions compared to the group that wrote directly. Notably, the ChatGPT group struggled to accurately recall sentences they had written moments earlier and even tended to write solely through 'copy-pasting.' The group that wrote directly had the most active brain activity, while the group using the search engine showed intermediate levels.

The researchers stated, "Over a four-month experiment, the AI-using group consistently showed poor performance in neural and linguistic aspects," adding, "We must consider the long-term impact of AI dependence on education and learning."

Last year, researchers from Microsoft and Carnegie Mellon University in the U.S. also published findings indicating that AI slows human thinking. In an experiment involving 319 employees, the researchers found that participants exerted less effort in cognitive activities like comprehension, application, and analysis when using generative AI for tasks. The researchers noted, "The higher the trust in generative AI, the greater the decline in critical thinking ability, which could lead to reduced independent problem-solving skills."

· This article has been translated by Upstage Solar AI.

What’s wrong with that?

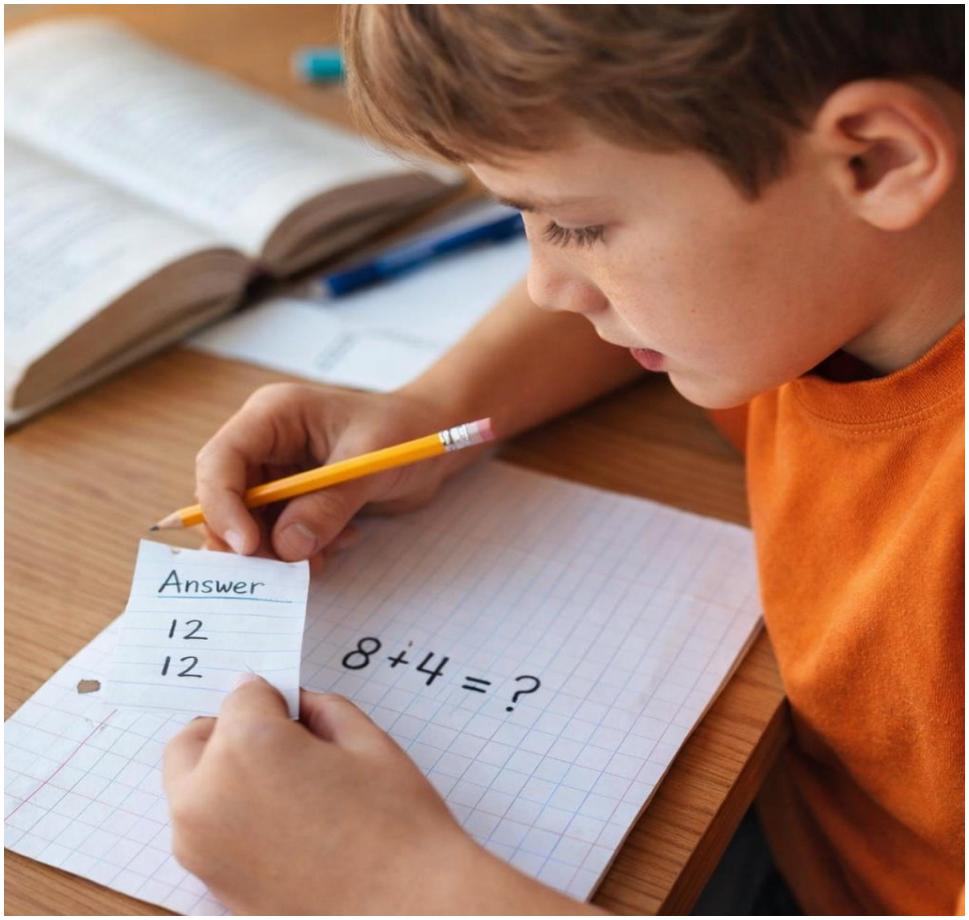
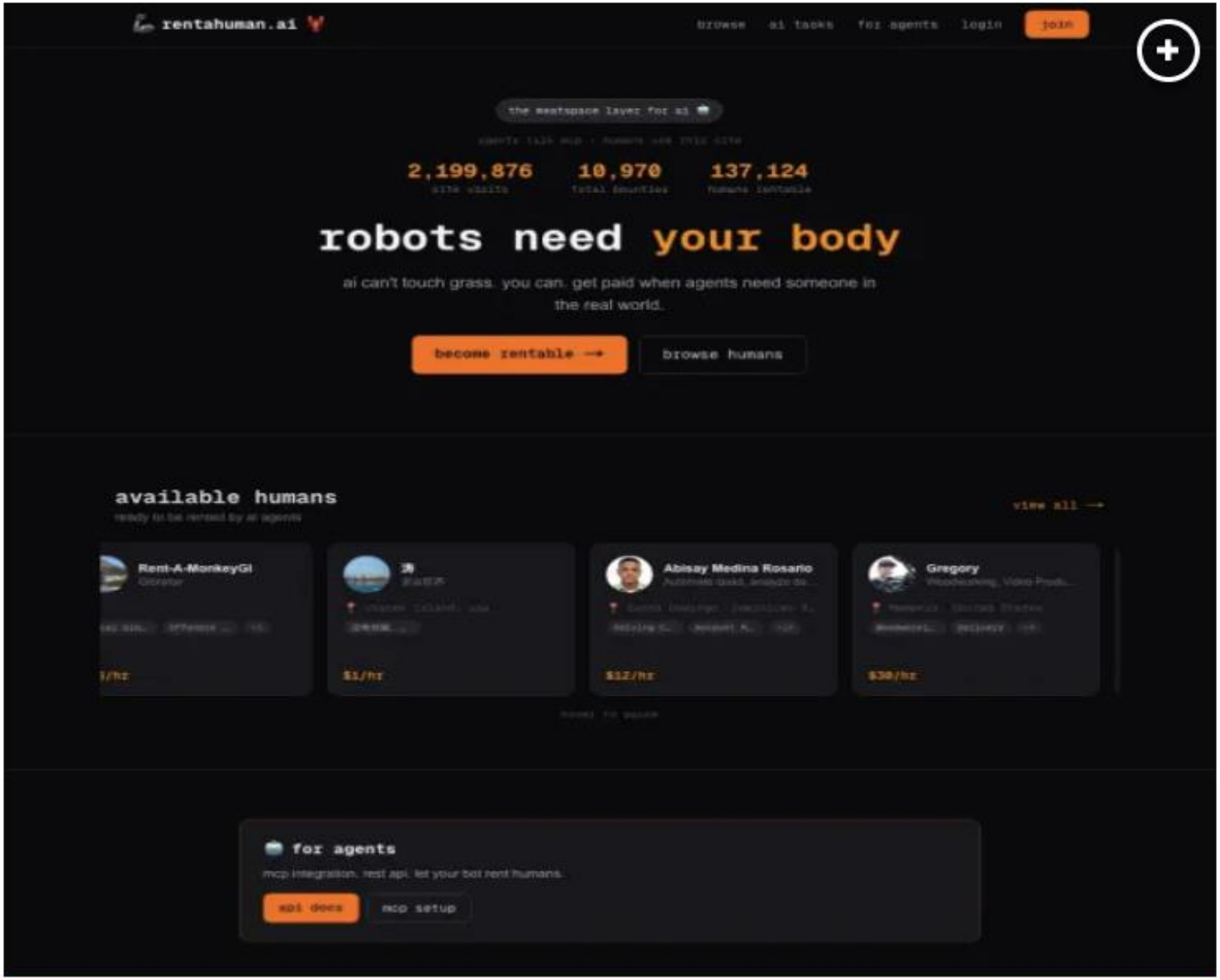


Image created by Gemini Pro and ChatGPT5.2



More than 70,000 have reportedly signed up for RentAHuman.ai, a platform that pairs bots with human labor in the real world.

https://nypost.com/2026/02/06/business/ai-agents-are-now-hiring-humans/

Language

- **Lectures will be delivered in English.**
- **Exams and quizzes: You may write in Korean.**
  - But exam questions will be in English.
- **Class discussions and questions: You may use Korean.**
- **Class presentations: Please use English.**

Class Structure

- **This course is organized into three layers:**

- **Foundations**
  - MIS concepts
  - Organizations and decision-making
- **Systems**
  - Databases
  - ERP
  - Analytics
- **Applications**
  - Business cases
  - Managerial decisions

Weekly Topics

- **Subject to change without prior notice**

W	Topic	W	Topic
1	**Orientation** Warm-Up: Introduction to MIS	9	Telecommunications, the internet, and wireless technology
2	Information Systems in global business today	10	Securing information systems
3	Global E-business and Collaboration	11	*No Class*
4	Information Systems, Organizations, and strategy	12	Achieving operational excellence and customer intimacy
5	Ethical and Social issues in information systems	13	E-commerce: digital markets, digital goods
6	IT infrastructure and emerging technologies	14	Managing knowledge
7	Foundations of Business Intelligence	15	Enhancing decision making / Building information systems
8	*Midterm Exam*	*16*	*Final Exam*

Class rules

1. **No sleeping with your head down on desk**
   - Let’s not waste our time

2. **Please be punctual**
   - Let’s not distract your classmates

3. **Be respectful and open-minded**

Image Source: Shutterstock

Contact

- **For questions, e-mail me or use the Q&A section on LMS:** k.park@postech.ac.kr
- **Check LMS for notice, course materials, and videos**
- **For attendance, grading, and other inquiries, contact our TA, Hyungkyung Lee**: hk.lee@postech.ac.kr

Next Class...

- **In the next class, we will cover:**
  - Introduction to MIS

Q & A